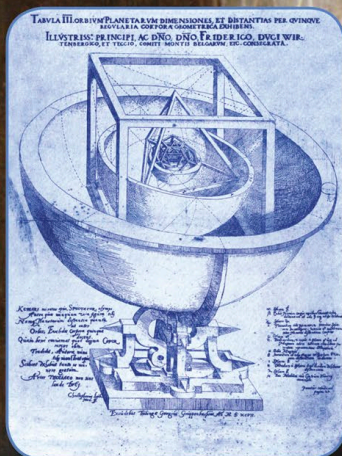


JOHANNES KEPLER

1571-1630

A great mathematician, Kepler calculated that each planet orbits the Sun in an oval path called an ellipse, travelling fastest when it is closest to the Sun, and slowest when it is further away. Kepler also discovered that the motions of planets depended on their distance from the Sun, but he did not know the reason why.

Kepler believed Earth had a soul, which affected weather and other phenomena.



Kepler's model of planetary orbits defended Copernicus's theory

DATA FILE



KEY DISCOVERY:
Laws of planetary motion



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: Germany



YEAR OF DISCOVERY: 1609